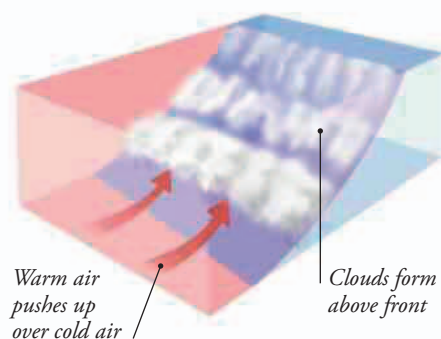


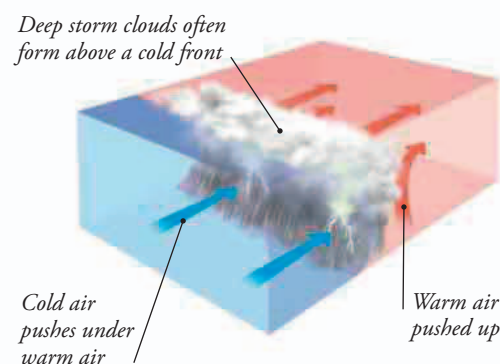


WEATHER FRONTS

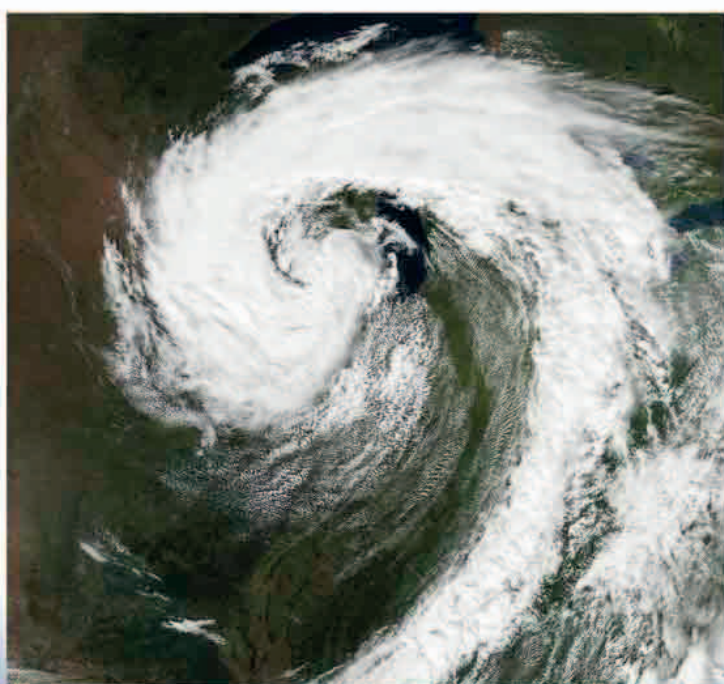
When warm air and cold air meet, the warm air rises above the colder, denser air at a boundary called a front. At a warm front, warm air slides up over cold air. At a steeper cold front, cold air pushes beneath warm air. At both kinds of front, warm air is forced upward, making it cooler. Any water vapor in the air turns to clouds and rain.



Warm front



Cold front



CYCLONES AND ANTICYCLONES

Earth's spin makes rising or sinking air spiral up or down. A rising, low-pressure spiral is called a cyclone. It carries warm, often moist air to higher altitudes, where it forms clouds like these. A cool, sinking, high-pressure spiral is called an anticyclone. The sinking air stops clouds from forming, leading to clear skies and dry weather.

FAST FACTS

- Cyclones swirl counterclockwise north of the equator, and clockwise south of the equator.
- Anticyclones spiral clockwise in the north, and counterclockwise in the south.
- If a fast-moving cold front overtakes a warm front, it lifts the warm air off the ground to form an occluded front.

UNDER THE WEATHER

Weather fronts are major features of the moving cyclones that bring bad weather to many parts of the world. A warm front arrives ahead of a cyclone. It causes falling atmospheric pressure, thickening clouds, and then rain. A cold front marks the end of the cyclone. It often brings sharp showers, but then the atmospheric pressure rises, the skies clear, and the Sun comes out.